

MATCHING TWO-PIECE BUSTLE SKIRT

Consisting of a tightly fitted bodice and long, trained skirt, this two-piece ensemble of striped, apricot silk displays the fashionable silhouette and longer bodice of 1874–75. Skirts narrowed, and volume shifted to the back to form a bustle. A bustle pad worn under the skirt provided the support. This style of skirt takes its inspiration from the 18th-century *polonaise* and is constructed in a similar way. Tapes fixed into the inside of the skirt allow it to be gathered up at the back. The wearer could also choose to loosen the tapes and have the skirts long, achieving the look of the alternative back and side views below.



BACK VIEW WITH
SKIRT DOWN



BACK VIEW
WITH SKIRT UP



SIDE VIEW WITH SKIRT DOWN



Ruched silk
applied to bodice

Concealed
hook-and-eye
fastening

Suede or kid
gloves would
have been worn

Flat-fronted skirt